

Workshop: Lap Sync

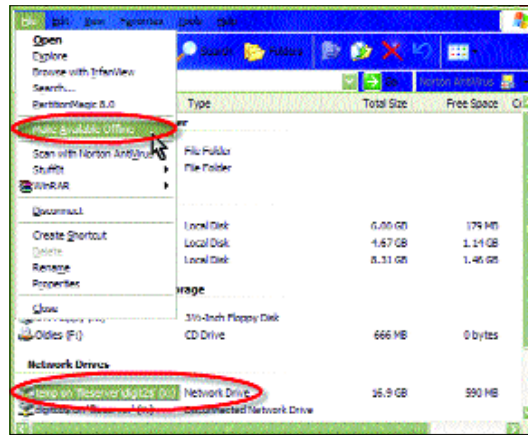
You've just returned from a business trip, and you start the process of transferring files from your laptop to your PC. With fingers and toes crossed, you pray that everything goes well. Even as you sit and search through folders to see which files aren't already on the PC, you contemplate quitting your job. Fortunately for you, we've got a simple solution. All you need do is let Windows XP's Offline files feature help you out of this predicament.

Enabling offline files

First, go to **Control Panel > User Accounts > Change the way users log on or off** and uncheck 'Fast User Switching'. Next, open My Computer, and go to **Tools > Folder Options**. Switch to the Offline Files tab, and ensure that 'Enable Offline Files' is ticked. Here, you'll also find options that let you decide about synchronising while logging on and off. Note that these affect all the network drives you set for synchronisation.

Map network drives

It's time now to create a network drive. Map a shared folder over the network using a drive let-



Drives available offline are synchronised once you plug the laptop into the network

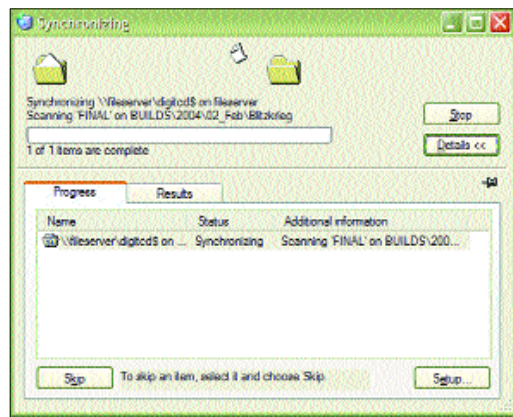
ter. On the laptop, open My Computer, and click **Tools > Map Network Drive**, choose a drive letter, and enter '\\computername\sharedfolder', where 'computername' is the name of your desktop PC, and 'sharedfolder' is the folder you've shared on the desktop computer. This folder should have read and write access in order to synchronise.

Networking offline

Click on the networked drive in My Computer and go to **File > Make Available Offline**. A wizard lets you set further options when you do this for the first time. This option is available only by going through the aforementioned path. To disable synchronization for a mapped drive, select the drive in My Computer, and go to **File > Make Available Offline** and remove the checkmark.

Synchronising

When you first make a network drive available offline, all the files are downloaded from your laptop to your desktop PC. Whenever you re-plug the laptop to the network and log on to Windows, the network drive is synchronised.



The Synchronisation Manager gives details of the process